

browsing a pain, adware are also notorious for hogging processor and memory resources, effectively turning your machine into a bullock cart. Look at the open source alternatives. They are adware-free and offer as good or superior functionality. Some of the more popular ones are:

- KaZaa Lite—This is a “clean” version of the popular KaZaa P2P client and contains no adware, spyware or any other potentially harmful software. It is especially easy for beginners. It is no longer being updated but every version of KaZaa Lite is available for download at <http://tinyurl.com/rala6>.
- Shareaza—A Windows-based, multi-network client that supports download from any of the following networks: eDonkey2000, BitTorrent, Gnutella, Gnutella2.

For a more comprehensive comparison, visit Wikipedia. For a list of P2P clients, visit <http://tinyurl.com/fbbvk>, and for BitTorrent clients, visit <http://tinyurl.com/9svye>.

13.1.4 P2P etiquette 1—Don't be a leech!

Because P2P is all about file sharing, it is considered good etiquette to leave your P2P client open when you are not downloading anything. This will allow other sharers like yourself to retrieve the files they want from your shared folder. A person who regularly downloads stuff from the network and does not upload anything is known as a leech. Some of the newer P2P software also tries to discourage leeching by enforcing a “share ratio,” which is the ratio of upload vs. download traffic. This is especially true in BitTorrent downloads, where trackers require users to maintain a minimum share ratio. So, within the limitations of juggling for bandwidth with your 56k dialup connection or staying within the transfer limit of your broadband connection, be good—don't be a leech and try and share as much as possible.

13.1.5 P2P etiquette 2—Don't kill the LAN!

File sharing is also bandwidth intensive. On a LAN, depending on the number of simultaneous uploads and downloads, a P2P client can